

Handoff Worksheet — Modern Applications -> Intelligent Data & AI

This worksheet is filled using the One-pager-scenario narrative and provides the Handout B fields for submission.

Handoff diagnostic

- Sending team / practice:

Modern Applications (Apps)

- Receiving team / practice:

Intelligent Data & AI (Data)

- Artifact handed off:

Versioned OpenAPI v3 spec and JSON Schema for Customer and Account entities; representative sample payloads (500–10,000 rows depending on complexity); migration-change-log (renames, type changes, deprecated fields, rationale); contract-test artifacts; PR checklist and human handoff note.

- Trigger / when does the handoff happen:

When the OpenAPI + JSON Schema PR is merged to the `contracts` repository with the `promote-to-shared` label and all contract-tests pass.

- Named owner on the sending side:

Apps Lead (signs the handoff PR and confirms contract-test green).

- Named owner on the receiving side:

Data Lead (acknowledges receipt, runs payload-compatibility validation, and signs validation report).

- What context is critical to the receiving team (top 3):

1. Field formats and types (date formats, GUID vs numeric IDs, exact string encodings).
2. Null semantics and cardinality constraints (which fields may be absent or multi-valued).
3. Migration-change rationale and recommended transformation rules (why a type changed, when a field is deprecated).

- What context typically gets dropped at this handoff (1–3 common losses):

1. Legacy edge-case formats (historical date encodings, vendor-specific delimiters).
2. Implicit normalization rules discussed verbally but not written (trimming, padding, case normalization).
3. Business rationale behind field shape choices (which affects aggregations or reporting semantics).

- Where AI can carry context across the handoff:

- Read OpenAPI/contract files via GitHub MCP and produce a structured ADR that documents ambiguous fields with examples.
- Generate expanded sample payloads containing likely edge cases using model-guided mutation rules.
- Auto-generate contract-tests and a human-readable validation report to attach to the PR.

- Where AI must not carry context across the handoff:

- Legal, privacy, and client-commitment approvals.
- Cross-team prioritization decisions that have schedule or cost impact.

- Format of the handoff payload:

A GitHub PR in the `contracts` repository containing:

- OpenAPI v3 and JSON Schema files (versioned)
- Attached sample payloads (or artifact links for large extracts)
- CHANGELOG.md entry noting the changes and rationale
- Contract-test artifacts and the PR checklist that @mentions the Data Lead

Data appends a validation-report artifact after running ingestion checks.

- Failure mode at this handoff:

ETL/parsing errors in Data ingestion due to format mismatches (e.g., date strings, GUID vs numeric mismatch), leading to failed cutovers, emergency adapters, and schedule slips.

- Recovery action:

1. Data opens a blocking issue in the PR and requests either an emergency transform from Apps or a corrected contract and sample payloads.

2. If Apps cannot immediately provide a fix, Data provides a temporary adapter to normalize inputs while a corrected contract is prepared.

- Validation that the handoff was clean:

- Data Lead posts a signed validation report artifact in the PR indicating pass/fail and any transform notes.

- The first downstream integration run against the shared environment succeeds and references the contract ID in logs and test artifacts.

- Schedule for revisiting this handoff:

- Revisit after each major migration milestone (end of phase), monthly during active migration, and quarterly post-migration until the legacy system is decommissioned.

Three self-check questions (answered):

1. Did you name an owner on the receiving side? Yes — Data Lead.
2. Did you name a specific failure the receiving team would face? Yes — ETL/parsing errors due to format mismatches (example: integer vs GUID customerId).
3. Could a third-practice colleague explain this handoff back to you? Yes — the workbook provides artifacts, contract IDs, and a PR-centric workflow so a third party could follow the PR and validation artifacts.

Worksheet completed and ready to include in the Week 6 Challenge submission.